

Gemini API quickstart



This quickstart shows you how to install our [libraries](#) and make your first Gemini API request.

Before you begin

Using the Gemini API requires an API key, you can create one for free to get started.

Create a Gemini API Key

Install the Google GenAI SDK

Python

JavaScript

Go

Java

C#

Apps Script

Using [Python 3.9+](#), install the `google-genai` package using the following [pip command](#):

```
pip install -q -U google-genai
```

Make your first request

Here is an example that uses the `generateContent` method to send a request to the Gemini API using the Gemini 2.5 Flash model.

If you [set your API key](#) as the environment variable `GEMINI_API_KEY`, it will be picked up automatically by the client when using the [Gemini API libraries](#). Otherwise you will need to [pass your API key](#) as an argument when initializing the client.

Note that all code samples in the Gemini API docs assume that you have set the environment variable `GEMINI_API_KEY`.

Python

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Apps Script

REST

```
from google import genai

# The client gets the API key from the environment variable `GEMINI_API_KEY`.
client = genai.Client()

response = client.models.generate_content(
    model="gemini-3-flash-preview", contents="Explain how AI works in a few words"
)
print(response.text)
```

What's next

Now that you made your first API request, you might want to explore the following guides that show Gemini in action:

- [Text generation](#)
- [Image generation](#)
- [Image understanding](#)
- [Thinking](#)
- [Function calling](#)
- [Long context](#)
- [Embeddings](#)

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Last updated 2026-03-27 UTC.